

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Vineet Bhati

Address: 11 Lincoln Terrace York Road Cheam SM2 6HE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Planning Officer,

I wish to formally object to planning application DM2025/01591.

My objection is based on material planning considerations, in particular highway safety, parking stress, pedestrian safety, and the impact on residential amenity arising from the site's close proximity to a primary school and surrounding residential properties. The proposed development is located in close proximity to a primary school. The intensified use of the site is likely to generate increased vehicle movements and pedestrian footfall, particularly during peak school drop-off and pick-up times. This raises serious concerns regarding highway safety, congestion, and the safety of children, parents, and other pedestrians using the surrounding streets and pavements. The proposal therefore conflicts with Sutton Local Plan Policy P26 (Transport and Parking), which seeks to ensure that development does not result in unacceptable impacts on highway safety, and with NPPF paragraphs 110 and 111, which require developments to provide safe and suitable access for all users and to avoid severe residual impacts on the road network.

The application does not demonstrate that sufficient on-site parking is provided to accommodate the scale and nature of the proposed use. This is likely to result in overspill parking on nearby residential streets, leading to obstruction of pavements, reduced visibility at junctions, and additional safety risks, particularly for school children. This is contrary to Sutton Local Plan Policy P26 and NPPF paragraph 110, which emphasise the importance of safe, well-managed movement and parking arrangements.

The proposal would also significantly increase pedestrian activity in an area already subject to high levels of pedestrian movement associated with the nearby primary school. The application fails to adequately assess the impact of this increased footfall on pedestrian safety, pavement capacity, and the overall safety of the local environment for children. This conflicts with Sutton Local Plan Policy P26 and NPPF paragraph 92, which seeks to promote safe, inclusive, and healthy communities, particularly for children and vulnerable users.

In addition, the intensified use of the site is likely to result in increased noise and disturbance from arrivals, departures, and associated activities, particularly during evenings and weekends. This would adversely affect the living conditions of nearby residents and is contrary to Sutton Local Plan Policy P14 (Residential Quality) and NPPF paragraph 185, which require development to be appropriate for its location and not give rise to unacceptable levels of noise or disturbance.

Overall, the proposal represents an over-intensification of use that is not appropriate for this predominantly residential location. It fails to respect the character of the area or safeguard residential amenity, contrary to Sutton Local Plan Policies P12 (Design) and P14, and NPPF paragraph 130, which requires development to be sympathetic to local character and establish a safe and high-quality environment.

For the reasons set out above, I respectfully request that the Council gives careful consideration to these material planning objections when determining this application.